



▲ **ASUS PB287Q**
Price: ₹54,000

Monitors

This is the year for 4K and high-res displays. Not many of us will spend more than ₹10,000 on a monitor of course, but the fact that we're slowly seeing 4K monitors trickle into the market means that it won't be long before 1080p starts looking old. Let's not forget Apple here either, their new retina iMac's will, if nothing else, present a very plausible case for higher resolution displays.

In terms of technology, there really isn't much to write about yet. We're seeing features like G-Sync and LightBoost, but the technology isn't yet mainstream and we'll probably have to wait until next year for such supported monitors to become more commonplace. In the meantime, well, there's IGZO, a panel technology that we have a lot of hope for, considering its potential for improving response time as well as reducing power consumption.

Other than that, there's not much to report. Monitors have markedly improved in quality since last year and it's now routine for us to see panels that offer contrast ratios in excess of 500:1. BenQ has been particularly prominent, offering some great HD displays (G series) at very reasonable prices (though you really should stay away from their E series panels)



BenQ BL3200PT
Price: ₹75,000



BenQ GW2255HM
Price: ₹9,700

and ASUS and Dell have both impressed us with their high-end IPS panels.

Zero1 Winner ASUS PB287Q

If you want 4K done right, then this is the monitor that you want. The monitor is among the more gorgeous ones we've tested and comes quite well-calibrated out-of-the-box. We measured a contrast ratio of about 700:1 at 75% brightness and a maximum supported brightness of 300cd/m2 with a 97% sRGB CIE graph, figures that are all the more impressive considering that this is a TN panel that we're talking about.

What all those fancy numbers mean is that the PB287Q is offering you the image quality of an IPS panel, with the response time of a TN one (up to 4ms according to our measurements, though it's rated at 1ms). Ideal for gaming, editing and anything else that you can think of doing with that panel. At a price of just Rs.54,000, this is a steal. The Dell UP3214Q is also a superb monitor to consider, if you really need 4K quality, but it's about three times the price and, the last time we checked, had major issues with lower resolutions.

Worthy Mentions BenQ BL3200PT

If it's contrast ratio you want, and our in possession of a highly flexible budget, this just might be the panel for you. The BL3200PT is a 32" 2K panel that offers up a contrast ratio of around 950:1, resulting in stunning image quality. The refresh rate does suffer owing to the VA technology that the monitor is based on and if you're a heavy gamer, you might have some trouble. Refresh rate aside, everything about this monitor screams quality. It's very well built and comes with a nice control pod as well. There really isn't anything we can say against the monitor other than the fact that it's a bit on the expensive side and that if it's really image quality you want, you can get cheaper, but smaller, IPS panels.

BenQ GW2255HM

For those on a budget, the GW2255HM has a lot to offer. You can pick it up for just under 10K and if you do, you won't be disappointed. What your money gets you is a very impressive contrast ratio of almost 1100:1 and a somewhat less impressive brightness of 240cd/m2. It's a VA panel, so as with the BL3200PT, the refresh rate is terrible, but the colours are as saturated as can be expected. The monitor is overly sharp and could do with a bit of tuning but other than that, it's a good deal at the price. **A**